6.5.3 Techniques of Breast Feeding

- Mother should be comfortable and relaxed physically and mentally before giving feed. She should wash her hand and can have a glass of milk or water. Mother should have no due work while feeding the baby.
- Baby should be cleaned and dried before feeding because, baby may feel discomfort or may not co-operate during feeding.

Positioning during Breast Feeding



- Sit or lie down comfortably with mother's back supported.
- Make sure the baby has one arm on either side of the breast as you pull the baby close.
- Use firm pillows or folded blankets under the baby to keep supported during the feeding.
- Support the baby's back and shoulder firmly.
- Once the baby's mouth is open wide, pull the baby quickly on your back.



Babies have a powerful sense of smell and can identify their mother's breast milk by scent.

Common positions used during breast feeding

a. Football position

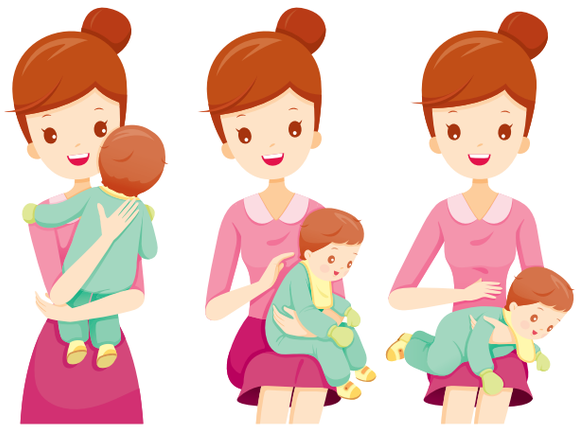
b. Cradling position

c. Lying down position

d. Across the lap position

e. Latching on position

6.5.4 Burping



All babies swallow air when they suck. They collect as a bubble in the babies stomach causing discomfort. So burping of the baby is essential to prevent aspiration of milk into trachea. Burping should be done each time after every feed. Put the baby over the mother's shoulder and give a gentle tap on the child's back, till the baby burps or for few seconds.

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